

1949, October 23.

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

CAPUCHIN FRANCISCAN
FATHERS

ST. FELIX FRIARY
HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

October 23, 1949

Mr. and Mrs. Alfred Holtz. Detroit, Michigan

My Dear Friends: God bless you and yours. God bless all our afflicted brethren of good (will). I received your pathetic letter yesterday and I surely do sympathize with you. What a disappointment to any loving parent to hear such a diagnosis. "Blindness, Deafness". I surely hope D. J. will give the doctors a surprise as nearly always happens when we trust in Almighty God. At all events how merciful has not God shown Himself to you in blessing you with another bright boy, and even in Donald's case, otherwise endowing him with such happy faculties!

And yet dear friends; what are all purely physical or temporal blessings in comparison with the faith that God has given us? - You and me, even though (we) differ, as may be, in some essentials. Besides, we have so much in common - and this we can say of all who honestly believe in God and hope in Him, that we ought surely to be patient with weaknesses so common, if not in systems of religion at least, in application and practice. The fact too, that there seems to be such an avalanche of atheism - the very climax of intellectual insanity and of moral depravity - threatening to inundate civilization: That ought to bring us all into mutual agreement and harmony of some kind.

At all events, we shall be pleased to join our prayers with yours in favor of poor dear little Donald Jay; viz. in "storming Heaven", that God be pleased to give him sight wherewith to glorify God Himself and promote - be instrumental in promoting - peace among men and nations. After all, as a science (and religion is, not only a science, but the greatest science of all ages) there can be but one religion, viz: "The science of our happy relationship with - dependence on - God and our neighbor." In the face of so much - such brazen and threatening atheism, is it not time we come together and get humanity to consider something about whether it is tending without faith in God and without fostering this greatest of all sciences, which outside of the comparatively few, refuse in their blindness even to recognize it as a science at all? Pardon the digression.

We shall hope and pray that little D. J. give the doctors a favorable surprise.

Very Sincerely Yours,
Fr. Solanus, O.F.M. Cap.